



Lower Your Rate Call Script

For your Strength: ten minutes on the phone can cut the interest you pay.

John says: Card companies say no to people who don't ask and, surprisingly often, yes to people who do. Here's exactly what to say.

Before you call

- ☐ Know your current rate (it's on your statement as APR).
- ☐ Know how long you've had the card and whether you've paid on time.
- ☐ Have one competing offer in mind: a mailer, an email, or a card advertised at a lower rate.
- ☐ Call the number on the back of the card and ask for a "rate review" or "retention."

The script

You: "Hi, I've been a customer since _____ and I've always paid on time. My rate is ____%, and I'm seeing offers around ____%. I'd like to stay with you. Can you lower my rate?"

If they say no: "I understand. Is there a promotional rate, a hardship program, or anyone in retention who can review my account?"

If they offer something small: "Thank you. Is that the best you can do today? I'm comparing this with a balance transfer offer."

Either way, finish with: "Can you note the account that I asked, and when would be a good time to check again?"

After the call

- Write down the date, who you spoke to, and the answer.
- If it's a no, call again in three to six months. Rates change, and so do the people answering.
- Any money saved from a lower rate goes to extra payments, not to a bigger balance.

Call log

Date	Card	Old rate	New rate	Check again on

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